



Laptops

Laptops have moved from being just drool-worthy gadgets restricted to the hands of a few, to devices of mass acceptance. This popularity is due to the notebook being a device of mass appeal; everybody wants a notebook, whether they really need one or not. Its one of those devices that has drool value and for many people being seen with a notebook is read as a status symbol. Falling prices are the other reason behind the sudden surge in market acceptance. Notebooks used to cost upward of Rs 50,000; you paid for the exclusiveness of owning a notebook. Taxes relating to their import have fallen and coupled with the reducing cost of components as market acceptance worldwide increases, a notebook is now much more affordable than you think.

Netbooks, an exciting and special (read cheap) category of notebooks are also available. These are very new entrants in the market and are based primarily on Intel Atom processors which consume hardly any power (2.5 to 4 watts). These netbooks are therefore available in very small sizes — 8.9 inches to 10.1 inches. Netbooks are mighty cheap and although you cannot get the same productivity out of them that a more powerful notebook PC would provide they are a serious option for those on a really small budget. Prices of netbooks range from Rs 20,000 to Rs 26,000.

